

021



BEMIDJI
STATE UNIVERSITY



**UNIVERSITY
IN THE PINES**

**WE ARE MINNESOTA'S
PREMIER NORTHWOODS
UNIVERSITY.**

To continue moving forward with our goal for unity, the brand guidelines have been updated. You'll find that the updated guide is more than just visual standards. These guidelines are here to help our community advance a consistent brand philosophy while creating a relevant connection to current and prospective students, faculty and community members.

Our progress in developing a consistent, unified brand message ultimately increases the number of individuals who are aware of Bemidji State University's remarkable sense of place, people and opportunities.

Everything starts from our heart



BSU Heritage

From our beginning in 1919 to today, Bemidji State believes in the transformative power of the liberal arts, education in the professions and the robust engagement of our students. We instill and promote service to others, preservation of the earth, and respect and appreciation for the diverse peoples of our region and world.

Relationships & Connections

For over 100 years our students have bonded with one another over their experiences at BSU and take that bond wherever they go. They also share a dynamic connection with the place we are at and the indigenous culture that thrives here. We are proud of our relationship with the region's four native nations and to be home to the oldest indigenous studies program in the country.

Northwoods Minnesota

Bemidji State introduces students to the beauty of our wilderness setting — the Minnesota Northwoods, a vast stretch of forests, wetlands and glacial lakes clustered around the Mississippi River's headwaters.



You wouldn't be the first person to consider wandering into the wilderness in the hope of coming out transformed. What is it about BSU that is magical, that invites us to ditch our assumptions, pack in bigger questions and more fully inform our aspirations? It's not like answers grow on trees or are carried by the wind. (Or are they?) We believe the drive to acquire deeper knowledge and develop greater wisdom is already in your nature. You simply need to find the right people and environment to help nurture it. Here, we invite you to come as you are, transform into whatever you can imagine and follow your own path.

The question is, how can you make the world a better place than you found it? **Find out.**



Personas



GENERATION Z

BORN BETWEEN ABOUT

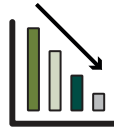
1997

&

2010s



MOST WERE RAISED BY
GEN XERS



GREW UP DURING
A **RECESSION**



TEND TO BE **PRAGMATIC**



FOCUSED ON
SAVING MONEY



MOBILE **NATIVES**



PREFER BRANDS THAT
FEEL AUTHENTIC



PREFER **SNAPCHAT**
& **INSTAGRAM**

COMMUNICATION PREFERENCES

- Authentic and relatable, above all else
- Personalization over mass communication
- Prefer to be engaged with (not talked at)
- Simplicity and minimalism
- Sell experiences, not products
- Unfiltered beats polished
- Video, video, video
- Text, not phone calls
- Attention span of 8 seconds (down from Millennial's 12 seconds)

CAREER ASPIRATIONS

- Socially active - 60% want their job to impact the world
- Hard workers - 76% wish their hobbies can become their careers (Millennials: 50%)
- Greatest aspirations after college: to be financially stable and to find a dream job

sources for graph: ZeroCater

Gen Z



Olivia Out of State

TRAITS

- High school junior or senior
- Lives in small-to-midsize town in outdoor-friendly states: Fort Collins, Colorado, Missoula, Montana, Idaho Falls, Idaho, Casper, Wyoming, Savannah, Georgia, Charleston, South Carolina, Flagstaff, Arizona, Farmington, Minnesota
- Lives in middle-class household
- Influenced by what she sees online, on social media and those she trusts in daily life

BELIEFS

- Considering a career in environmental/wildlife/fisheries
- Grew up around the outdoors and hunting/fishing/camping
- Understands the importance of nature conservation
- Wants to feel a connection with where she goes to school
- Not interested in large-town living
- Hasn't explored out-of-state higher education due to out-of-state tuition costs
- Underwhelmed with in-state options that give her a comfortable place to learn but don't speak to her passions

STATEMENT

"I live for the outdoors; it's in my blood. You're telling me I can do that for a career? Sign me up! But, I don't know if those options exist near me. The schools here are beautiful and would let me enjoy the outdoors while I go to school, but will I get the right degree to let me pursue my passion? I don't know. Looking outside of my home state feels like it's just going to make it too expensive for me with out-of-state tuition."



Ricky Regional

TRAITS

- High school junior or senior – in the top 30-70% of their graduating class
- Lives in small towns in Northern Minnesota (north of Brainerd): Bemidji, Park Rapids, Grand Rapids, Ely
- First-generation college student
- Lives in blue-collar, lower-income household
- Influenced by what he sees online, on social media and those he trusts in daily life

BELIEFS

- Not sure if he wants to go to college and what he would want to study
- Grew up around the outdoors and hunting/fishing
- Understands the importance of nature conservation
- Not interested in large-town living (“Bemidji and Grand Rapids are already a little too big”)
- Small-town feel is comfortable: community feel with personal attention/relationships
- Finances are his biggest concern about going to college

STATEMENT

“I don’t know what to do when I graduate, but it’d be great if I could find a job that meshed with my hobbies. My mom and dad got decent jobs in town after high school, but I feel like I might be built for more. I love being from a small town: we all know each other, hang out and have fun. I get nervous thinking about going to college in the cold, concrete jungle of bigger cities. All I want to do is go to school and enjoy the outdoors after class with my buddies.”



Sam Suburban

TRAITS

- High school junior or senior
- Lives in the northern Metro suburbs and other mid-sized Minnesota towns: Maple Grove, St. Cloud, Brainerd/Baxter, Mankato, Duluth
- Lives in middle-class household
- Has several college options available to him (could likely attend any 4-year in Minnesota)
- Influenced by what he sees online, on social media and those he trusts in daily life

BELIEFS

- Considering a career in environmental/wildlife/fisheries
- Grew up outdoors going camping and to the cabin
- Wants to feel a connection with where he goes to school
- Feels a connection to the Bemidji area (family cabin, family member is a BSU alum, teacher or another influencer went to BSU)
- Underwhelmed with 4-year schools closer to home that he doesn't feel connected to

STATEMENT

"I love going Up North; my family has a cabin up there and I spent every summer growing up at the lake. There are lots of places I could go to college, but I need to feel a connection to wherever I go. I don't know if I want to go to school in the middle of a cornfield or go to a big school where I'm just going to be another number. I want my college experience to mean something when I'm done."



Izzy American Indian

TRAITS

- High school sophomore, junior or senior
- Lives on American Indian reservations across the Upper Midwest, especially Minnesota
- First-generation college student, might currently attend a tribal college
- Lives in a blue-collar, low-income household
- Influenced by what she sees online, on social media and her tribe's elders/influencers

BELIEFS

- College is not the default societal choice for graduating seniors
- Not sure if she wants to go to college and what she would want to study
- Wants to feel a deeper connection with and better understanding of her indigenous roots
- Wants to expand knowledge and skills beyond what is available to her on the reservation

STATEMENT

"The college decision is a big deal. My heritage is important to me, and I want need to better understand my ancestors and my roots. I'd be the first person in my family to go to college, so there would be a lot of pressure to make my family proud. And, the thought of maybe being the only American Indian on campus is scary, which makes it easier to think about staying at home."



Tara Transfer

TRAITS

- Early 20s
- Currently attending a two-year school (technical college, community college, vocational college)
- Lives throughout Minnesota where she can attend two-year college: Bemidji, Grand Rapids, North Metro, Duluth, Alexandria, Fergus Falls, St. Cloud, etc.
- Currently works full-time in a lower-paying, entry-level job in her desired field
- Influenced by what she sees online, on social media and her life experiences

BELIEFS

- Interested in leveling up her career potential with a four-year degree
- Pursuing a four-year degree is a means to an end; she's not as focused on the "student experience"
- Decision comes down to how her credits will transfer and if she can continue her existing learning path
- Finances are a concern: she may have started attending a two-year college due to lower cost versus "expensive" four-year schools
- Her education must fit within her other commitments while she juggles multiple responsibilities: working full-time, maybe raising a family, paying a mortgage, etc.

STATEMENT

"My life feels crazy right now. I'm trying to juggle the 'real world' with the thought of continuing my education and chasing a four-year degree. I have responsibilities now that I can't ignore, so I need to figure out how to balance pursuing a bachelor's degree while working full-time and paying my bills. But, it'd be a means to an end: the four-year degree would let me level up at work. I'll need to remind myself of that as life gets a little crazier."

Our guiding principles

SEVEN GRANDFATHER TEACHINGS

Bemidji State University acknowledges that this land, which is nestled among the pines and along the shores, is known as Bemijigamaag igo gaye Makoce and is the current and ancestral homeland of the Ojibwe, Dakota and Lakota. Anishinaabe people live side-by-side with non-Natives who occupy Indigenous land. The Anishinaabe are the spiritual and physical caretakers of this land to which we belong. We are committed to uplifting the names of these sacred lands as well as the community members from these nations.

We are inspired to leave the world better than we found it by instilling core human values embodied by the traditional Seven Grandfather Teachings. These teachings are commonly shared from coast to coast in various forms, and have been adopted as moral stepping-stones or cultural foundations by many indigenous people.

These teachings provide Bemidji State University with a broad philosophy which encompasses our beliefs, mission and values. These beliefs and values guide us in all circumstances, irrespective of changes to our goals, strategies or type of work. These beliefs and values create a culture where everyone understands what's important.

Teachings adapted from information found at unitingthreefiresagainstviolence.org

No. 1 HUMILITY

THE WOLF



Humility is to know that we are a part of creation. We must always consider ourselves equal to one another. We should never think of ourselves as being better or worse than anyone else. Humility comes in many forms. This includes compassion, calmness, meekness, gentleness and patience. We must reflect on how we want to present ourselves to those around us and be aware of the balance and equality with all of life — including humans, plants and animals.

Adapted from nhbpi.org

BRAND TONE

We must remember our brand is an entity unto itself. It's a living, breathing organism and must be looked upon objectively. We must put the brand ahead of our subjective views and do what's right to nurture it.

BRAND MESSAGING

We need to be empathetic. Let's look through the eyes of our core audiences and remember they are the ones that we need to be engaging — not ourselves.

No. 2 BRAVERY

THE BEAR



Facing a problem with integrity is a true demonstration of bravery. We do what is right even when the consequences may be unpleasant. We face life with the courage to use our personal strengths to face difficulties, stand tall through adversity and make positive choices. We must stand up for our convictions and have courage in our thinking and speaking. All of these actions together will lead to ceaseless bravery. *Adapted from nhbpi.org*

BRAND TONE

The work we put forward should show BSU's strength. We will use forms that are bold and simple.

BRAND MESSAGING

As it says above, "we must stand up for our convictions." While these convictions may go against the grain of traditional conversation, we can't be scared to talk about them. This is what makes us, us.

No. 3 HONESTY

THE SABLE



Facing a situation takes bravery, but it takes honesty to not only do the right thing, but also to say the right thing. If we are honest with ourselves, this will allow us to be honest with others. We walk through life with integrity, with truth as our guide. In an atmosphere of truth and honesty, we give full value to our efforts and the efforts of others. When we act upon truths through straight-forward, clear and appropriate communication, with honesty as our foundation, we create trust. *Adapted from nhbpi.org*

BRAND TONE

Our designs will embrace restraint, focusing on clarity, legibility and imagery of the authentic elements that surround us.

BRAND MESSAGING

Our designs will be authentic and tell the truth about our environment. When creating messages for others, consider how you wish to be talked to — others usually want to be talked to in that same way. Avoid the academic lingo used by other universities.

No. 4 WISDOM

THE BEAVER



The combination of these seven teachings, combined with the experiences of life, leads to wisdom — which we use to create a world that is better than the one we inherited from our predecessors. Wisdom also carries other meanings such as intelligence or knowledge. When we cherish our knowledge or intelligence, we also cherish our wisdom. This wisdom guides as we develop our relationships with others and guides our course of action. In addition to our own wisdom, we must learn to listen to and be guided by the wisdom of others in our community and region. We must remember that wisdom comes in all shapes, sizes, forms and ages. *Adapted from nhbpi.org*

BRAND TONE

Our design elements and concepts should tell the bigger story of transformation. This is not just about single pieces, this is always about the bigger picture. Ask yourself how all of the pieces come together.

BRAND MESSAGING

Our messages must reflect our institutional priorities. They not only tell our audiences who we are, but also that BSU is a place where they can transform and grow.

No. 5 TRUTH

THE TURTLE



Truth is contained in the knowledge that we create. Truth gives us the ability to act without regret. We must understand, speak and feel the truth while also honoring its power. We know who we are as an institution, and we do not deal in deceptions. Our emotional, physical and intellectual gifts will guide us — and our students — on our journey. *Adapted from nhbpi.org*

BRAND TONE

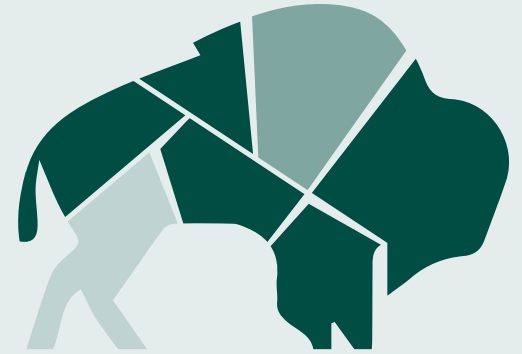
Sometimes less is more. We don't need to overcomplicate our designs to make them beautiful. The beauty behind a single image, word or texture may be all we need.

BRAND MESSAGING

Lead with your hearts and tell BSU's story through our people. They have the perspectives and diversity that our audiences will relate to.

No. 6 RESPECT

THE BUFFALO



We demonstrate respect by realizing the value of all people and all things, and by showing courteous consideration and appreciation. We must give respect if we wish to be respected. We honor ourselves and others. We honor the roles we play in the educational journeys of others through the knowledge that has been shared with us and the knowledge we create in others. We are not to bring harm to anyone or anything. Respect is not just an action, but a feeling at our core. *Adapted from nhbpi.org*

BRAND TONE

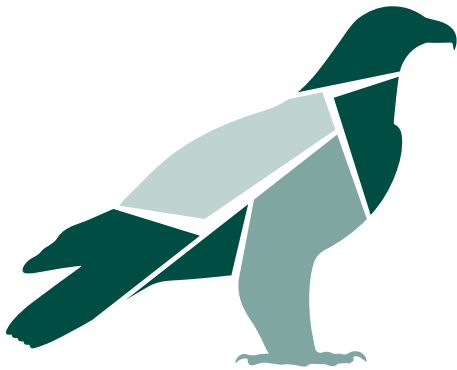
When we do our work, we should think about the materials that we are using and make sure we are being environmentally and community friendly.

BRAND MESSAGING

At all times, remember we have different cultures, communities and points of view at BSU. It is our job to make sure we understand these before messaging.

No. 7 LOVE

THE EAGLE



To know love is to know peace, and our love must be unconditional. Love is an attachment based upon devotion, admiration, tenderness and kindness. People need love the most when they are weak. We have strong affection for all members of our communities — love knows no bounds. We must accept it sincerely and give it freely. *Adapted from nhbpi.org*

BRAND TONE

We love BSU and we love our Minnesota north woods setting. At all times, we show our community enjoying our surroundings — respecting and nurturing our environment and each other.

BRAND MESSAGING

The love for BSU stretches far beyond our north woods. We have alumni across the world doing amazing things they love. Their enthusiasm is infectious. It is important to show our love toward this community.



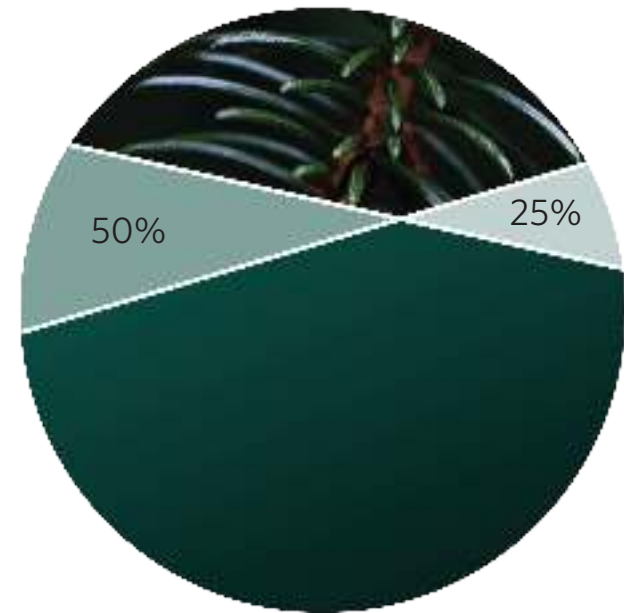
Our true colors

Green and White

Bemidji State University's school colors of green and white were adopted in 1920.

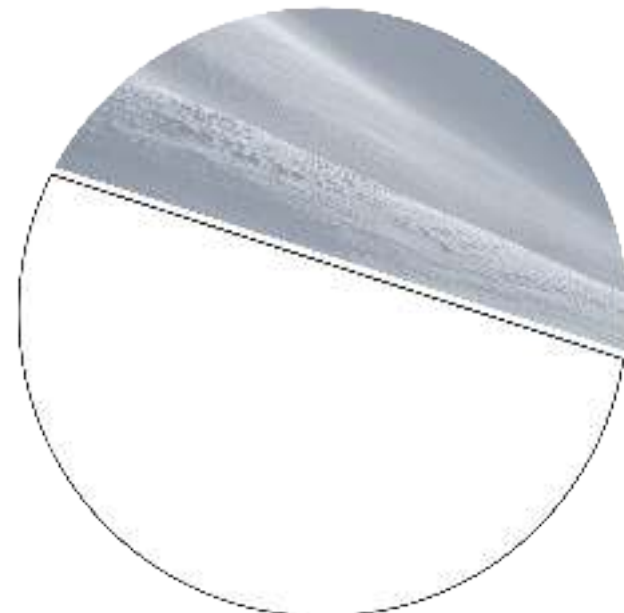
An assembly hour was set aside for the selection of colors, and after initial balloting resulted in a deadlock a student named Cyrillus Freeman arose from her seat and said, "As we sat here discussing the question, I happened to glance out the window. The sight that met my eyes was fresh green pines silhouetted against pure white snow. What could be more appropriate than green and white?"

On the first round of balloting, her choice of colors had received one vote, but after her remarks, according to the report, her idea "was immediately accepted unanimously."



EVERGREEN

PANT 3305 • RGB 0 - 77 - 67 • CMYK 94 - 45 - 69 - 42 • INDX 004D43



SNOW

PANT WHT • RGB 255 - 255 - 255 • CMYK 00 - 00 - 00 - 00 • INDX FFFFFFFF



WATER



SKY



FIRE



ICE



EARTH



BIRCH



FROSTED LEAF



NIGHT



LEAF



FOREST



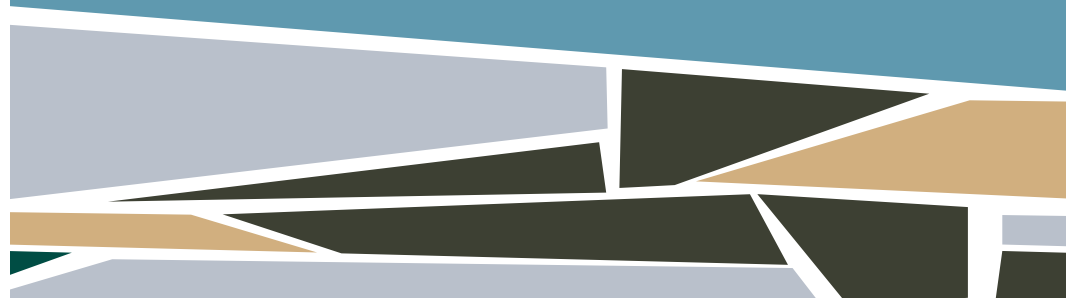
FEATHER



SUNSET

Our palette

Our secondary palette is derived from the beautiful colors of nature. These colors are meant to complement our green and white, but should not replace or overpower them. Our logo should never be reversed out of them or be colored with them.



Our identity

Bemidji State University's logo embodies our philosophies, values and sense of place. It illustrates the source of our name — a lake with water flowing through it. The logo is a sacred piece of our identity and should be used under strict guidelines. The four examples to the right are the only ways our logo should be used.



BEMIDJI
STATE UNIVERSITY

2 COLOR



BEMIDJI
STATE UNIVERSITY

1 COLOR



BEMIDJI
STATE UNIVERSITY

REVERSED



BEMIDJI
STATE UNIVERSITY

TEXTURAL REVERSED

DO NOT CHANGE THE
COLORS OF THE LOGO



DO NOT USE THE
SECONDARY COLORS



DO NOT REVERSE IT OUT ON
ANY COLOR EXCEPT GREEN



NEVER USE THE TYPE ALONE



DO NOT STRETCH, SKEW
OR ADD A STROKE TO IT



DO NOT USE THE VISUAL
LOGO ALONE OR CROPPED



DO NOT USE IT OVER COMPLEX IMAGES
AND IT ALWAYS NEEDS TO BE LEGIBLE



DO NOT USE DROP SHADOWS



RECOMMENDED CLEAR SPACE



MINIMAL SIZE 1.5 in

Department lock up



Horizontal

Vertical



Alumni&Foundation



2 COLOR

Alumni&Foundation



1 COLOR

Alumni&Foundation



REVERSED

Alumni&Foundation



AIRC

Bemidji State University was the first college or university in Minnesota to offer an Indian studies program, and we are home to the world's oldest collegiate Ojibwe language program. At the heart of our indigenous studies offerings is the American Indian Resource Center, which has offered support and programming for our American Indian and indigenous students since 2003.

Because we are located between Minnesota's three largest American Indian reservations — Leech Lake, Red Lake and White Earth are all within 50 miles of Bemidji — BSU has easy, immediate access to a large number of fluent speakers, spiritual leaders, Indian educators and cultural offerings. The AIRC also serves a regional center, offering engagement and support opportunities for native nations and other organizations throughout Minnesota.



The AIRC logo can only appear on white

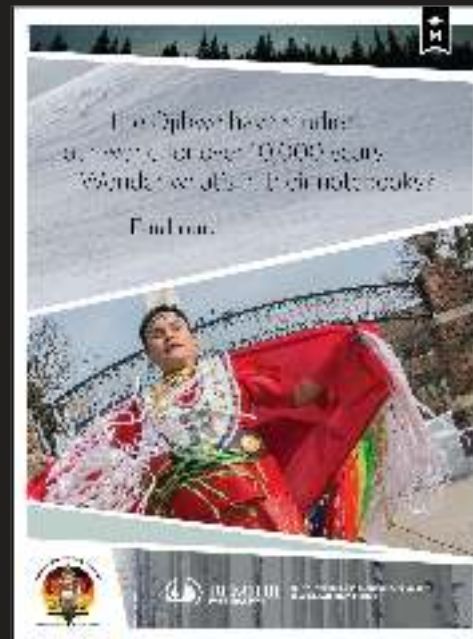


University Lockup

Letterhead
Business Cards
Signage



When using the two logos together, the BSU logo should appear on textures and the AIRC logo should appear on white. See examples below.





Woods Water

Let's **type**

The Whitney type family, originally developed for New York's Whitney Museum, contends with two different sets of demands: those of editorial typography and those of public signage.

There are 12 styles in the Whitney family:

Light
Light Italic

Semibold
Semibold Italic

Book
Book Italic

Bold
Bold Italic

Medium
Medium Italic

Black
Black Italic

Adobe Garamond is our secondary font.

We use 4 styles of Adobe Garamond:

Regular
Regular Italic

Bold
Regular Italic

Example headline style

LIGHT SENTENCE CASE

SEMIBOLD SENTENCE CASE
TO CALL OUT WORDS

Introductory headline

ADOBE GARAMOND

Bemidji introduces you to the beauty of our wilderness setting — The Minnesota Northwoods region, a vast stretch of forests, wetlands and glacial lakes clustered around the Mississippi River's headwaters in the central part of the state, which has attracted hikers, campers and families for thousands of years. It easily could have remained a network of sleepy little resort towns lulled into complacency by the sheer bounty of protected green spaces and more than 1,000 glittering lakes.

Northwoods towns have specialized to offer a range of experiences, tempting travelers with lazy lake days and campfire nights at family-run resorts, window shopping along old-fashioned Main Streets and a comprehensive trail network that allows hikers, horseback riders, birdwatchers and cyclists to venture deep into the forests, bogs and bottomlands.

BODY COPY
WHITNEY MEDIUM
12pt
15pt Leading

CALL OUTS

SEMIBOLD ALL CAPS 8pt - 25 Track

Example headline style

LIGHT SENTENCE CASE CAN BE
USED FOR THE WHOLE HEADLINE

Introductory headline

WHITNEY SEMIBOLD

Bemidji introduces you to the beauty of our wilderness setting — The Minnesota Northwoods region, a vast stretch of forests, wetlands and glacial lakes clustered around the Mississippi River's headwaters in the central part of the state, which has attracted hikers, campers and families for thousands of years. It easily could have remained a network of sleepy little resort towns lulled into complacency by the sheer bounty of protected green spaces and more than 1,000 glittering lakes.

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BODY COPY
ADOBE GARAMOND 12pt
15pt Leading

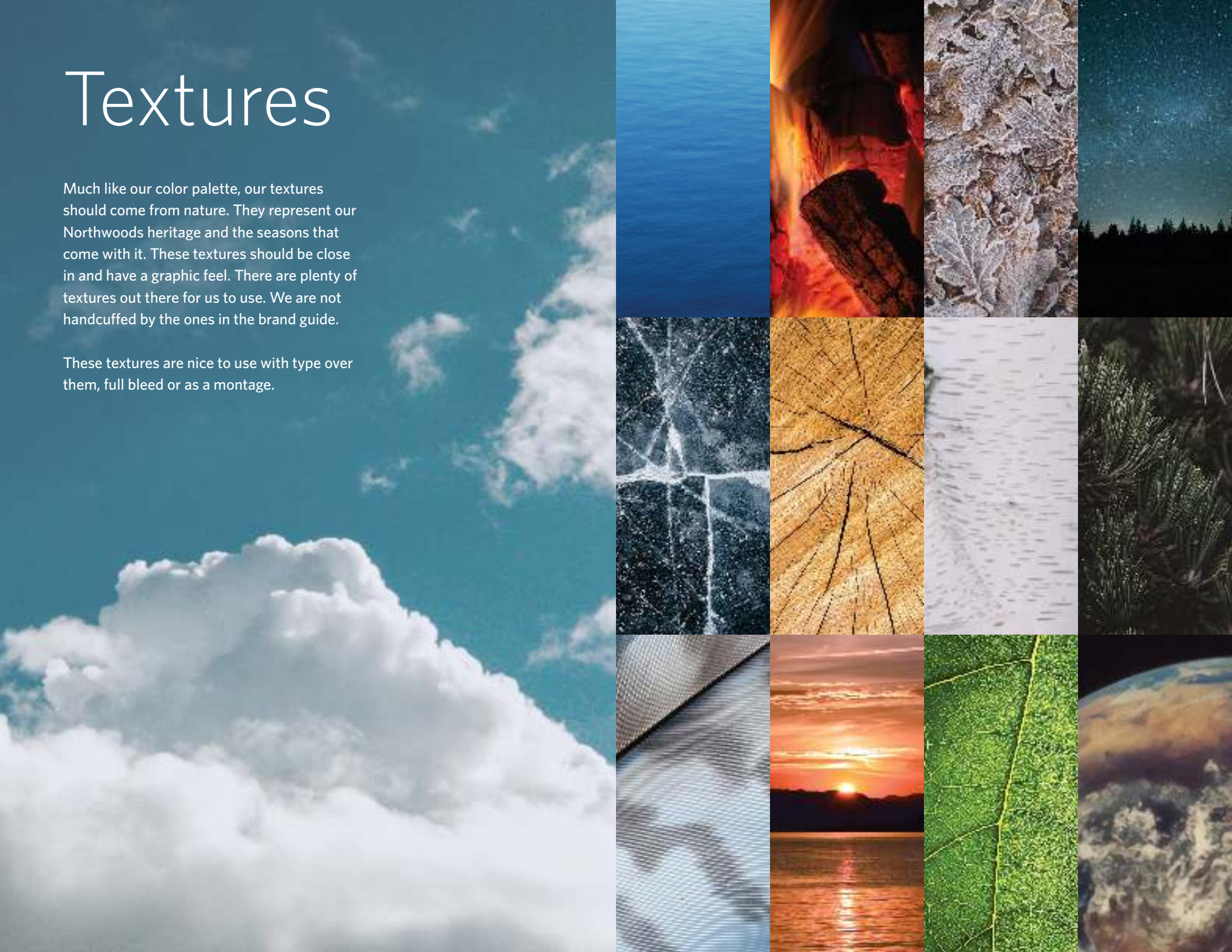
CALL OUTS

WHITNEY SEMIBOLD

Textures

Much like our color palette, our textures should come from nature. They represent our Northwoods heritage and the seasons that come with it. These textures should be close in and have a graphic feel. There are plenty of textures out there for us to use. We are not handcuffed by the ones in the brand guide.

These textures are nice to use with type over them, full bleed or as a montage.





Playing with **patterns**

No. 1 • BARK - ICE - ROCK

This primary pattern can be used in a multitude of ways, but remember it isn't the only part to our brand language. This pattern should enhance our designs, not define them. This bark, ice and rock pattern can be used as a background or page breaker, as a subtle design enhancer or a mask, or to create iconography or signage. The possibilities for this pattern are as endless as the natural world that inspires it.



Image
example



Icon example

Signage
example

Northwoods towns have specialized to offer a range of experiences, tempting travelers with lazy lake days and campfire nights at family-run resorts, window shopping along old-fashioned Main Streets and a comprehensive trail network that allows hikers, horseback riders, birdwatchers and cyclists to venture deep into the forests, bogs and bottomlands.

Detail
example

No. 2 • THE PINES

Our secondary pattern should be used in subtle ways that can help our primary pattern.



The pine pattern should always be green or textured against a lighter “sky.”

Do not reverse the values (such as white trees against a green sky).



Crop Pine Texture

Tone on Tone



Individually



With Pattern





Photos

Our photos should be journalistic and in the moment to capture the story and true emotion of the image. We are documenting these experiences by being there but not being seen. It's this candid approach that shows an authentic point of view for people, places and time.



IN THE MOMENT

PORTRAITS

MACRO TO MICRO

IN THE FIELD





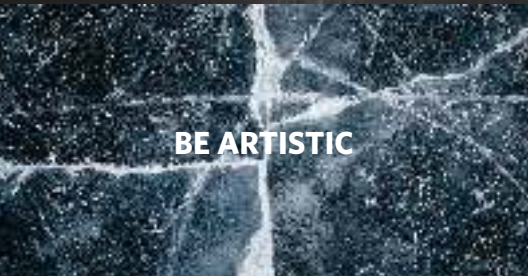
THE HISTORY



BE CULTURAL



FIND DYNAMIC ANGLES



BE ARTISTIC



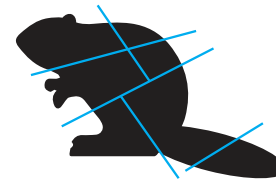
How to make our icons

It's fun to make icons but we want to make sure our icon system is consistent. Here are four easy steps to make ours.



Step 1

Draw a black and white flat icon. It can be of anything you might be needing to represent.



Step 2

Use the line tool in Illustrator to divide the icon. After this, outline the lines and merge them. Send them to the back and then use the minus back tool in the path finder.



Step 3

To get the imperfections of the lines, take the selection tool and grab individual points of the forms. Use the arrows to move them where you would like.



Step 4

Choose the pieces to color them. One piece should be 50% green and one piece can be 25% green.



BEMIDJI
STATE UNIVERSITY

launch campaign

The Territory:

Source of Truth

A journey of personal discovery and inner transformation.

The Tone:

Indigenous Spirit

Inspiring your inner spirit to make the world a better place than you found it.

Intimate - Wise - Magical

The Idea: **Find out.**

This is about the story within all of us.
It is the answer to the bigger questions
we have and is our call to action for
those looking for more.

Inspiring your inner spirit to make the world a better
place than you found it.



Messaging Find out.

Our messages always must relate to our brand purpose of inner transformation and be guided by our core principles. When writing, we are looking for dynamic ideas that can truly be owned by us, Minnesota's premier Northwoods university and answer the challenge to "find out." Look to the Northwoods area, BSU and Bemidji to find your inspiration. Look for the truth of what we deliver that no one else can. Pair these truths with transformation and you will have our voice.

Never be cliché when using outdoor terms or phrases and never use puns.

Call to Action

We need to also make sure that we are driving our audience to specific action or places in our marketing material. By doing so, we can control where and when we need them to take action.

Example:

**FIND OUT HOW YOU CAN UNEARTH YOUR
WISDOM WITHIN @ BEMIDJISTATE.EDU/FINDOUT**

Can you conquer
your wilderness within?

Find out.



— BRAVERY

Is curiosity the
headwaters of wisdom?

Find out.

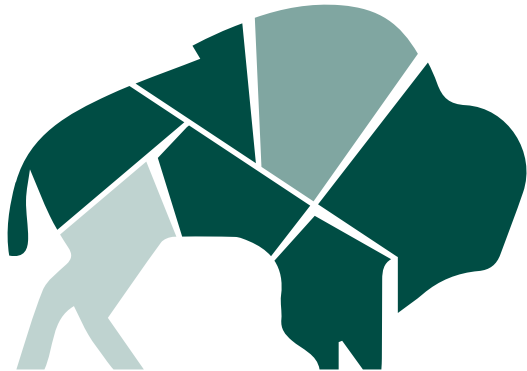


— WISDOM

Does ninety acres of campus
surrounded by hundreds of square
miles of headspace transform you?

Find out.

HUMILITY



The Ojibwe have studied
our world for over 10,000 years.
Wonder what's in their notebooks?

Find out.

RESPECT

Why is the beaver an
American Indian symbol
for wisdom?

Find out.

LOVE



Long copy

We want to think of ourselves as outdoor journalists when writing long copy. It needs to tell a story and engage the reader. We are not just telling facts. We are writing about a place we love, our dynamic people, rich history, interesting events and communities that bonds us together. Our audiences are looking for the story.

PRESENT

Enrolling more than 5,100 students, Bemidji State offers more than 80 undergraduate majors and eight graduate degrees encompassing arts, sciences and select professional programs. BSU is a member of the Minnesota State system of colleges and universities and has a faculty and staff of more than 550. The university's Shared Fundamental Values include environmental stewardship, civic engagement and international and multicultural understanding.

FUTURE

Bemidji State University introduces you to the beauty of our wilderness setting. The Minnesota Northwoods region, a vast stretch of forests, wetlands and glacial lakes clustered around the Mississippi River's headwaters in the north part of the state, has attracted students here for years. It's this setting that fosters a common bond between our students, our faculty and our environment.

Campaign examples





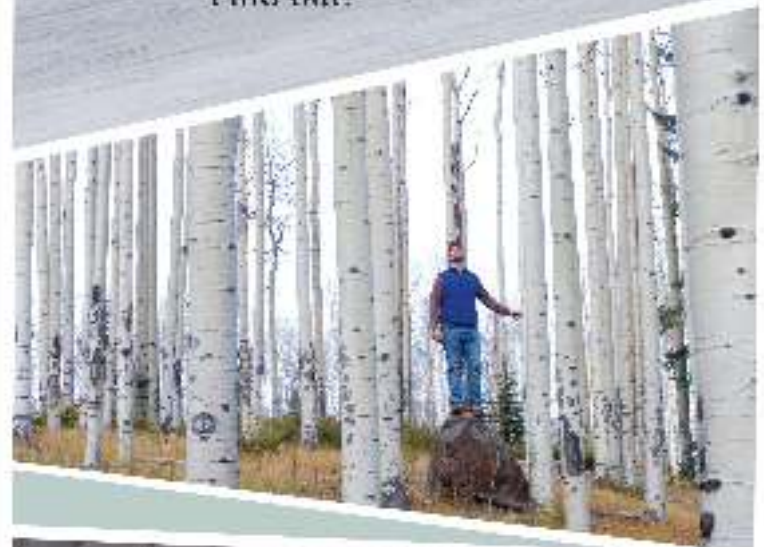
Can you conquer
your wilderness within?
Find out.



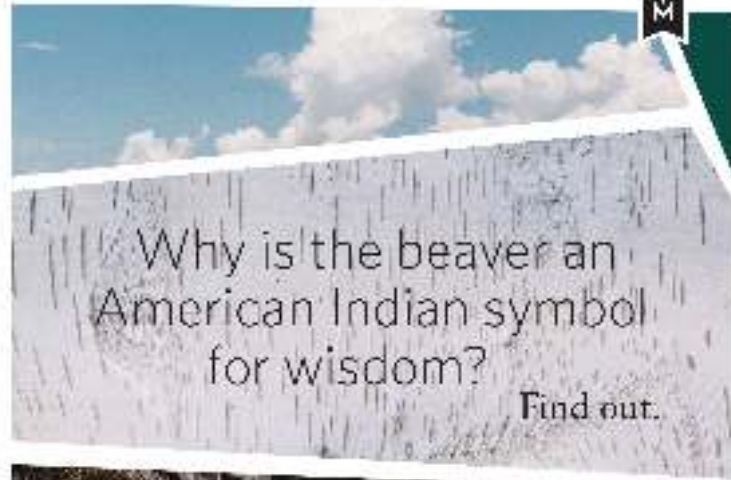
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Is curiosity the
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Find out.



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